Before it hits the block.

A block is the settled thing. Public, final, already priced in. Alpha is what has not landed on it yet. This is the room where it gets said first.

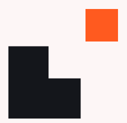
A block, with one piece off it

The name already contains the idea. A block is public, final, and by the time something is on it, everyone already has it. Alpha is whatever has not hit the block yet. Off the block is where that gets said first.

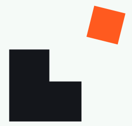
So the mark is a square with a square notch bitten out of its corner, and the piece that came out is now clear of it, tilted. Two properties carry the whole thing, and both of them are the kind that quietly disappear if nobody writes them down.

One: the block is orthogonal, the piece that left is not

Every edge of the block sits at ninety degrees, because a block is settled. The loose piece is tilted 14 degrees, because it is not.



TILT REMOVED · SAYS NOTHING



THE MARK

> Set the tile square to the block and it collapses into a square and a smaller square, tidily arranged. The tilt is the argument.

Two: the piece must clear the hole it came out of

The void is half the logo. If the tile does not fully clear its notch, the notch is covered and the mark reads as a square with a tile stuck on it: an object with a decoration, rather than an object and its absence.

GAP CLOSED · THE VOID IS GONE

THE MARK

> So the gap is not a distance that was nudged until it looked right. It is solved for from the tilted tile's own bounding extent, which is why it holds at every size and every tilt.

02 · GEOMETRY

The mark, as numbers

Everything is derived from four numbers. The build scripts read them from `geometry.py`; nothing else decides what the mark looks like.

```
block  36
tile   16  (44% of the block)
gap    2.5  (guaranteed, both axes)
tilt   14°

ink    57.90 × 57.90  (square)
balance 38.0% across, 62.0% down
```

The ink comes out exactly square, and not by luck: the block runs back from its corner and the tile runs forward from it by the same extent plus the gap in both axes.

PRIMARY

Why the tile stops at 44% of the block

The notch is the tile's own width taken out of the block's edge. A tile at half the block or more bites away more than half that edge, and what is left stops reading as a square with a piece missing. It becomes a plain L. An L is a corner. The name is the block, so it has to read as one.

TILE AT 67% · READS AS AN L

TILE AT 44% · READS AS A BLOCK

The micro variant, below 24px

The gap is the first thing to die. At 16px, 2.5 units of daylight is under one device pixel: the block and the tile fuse into one grey lump and the mark says nothing. Micro widens the gap, grows the tile so it survives as more than a speck, and flattens the tilt, because a 14 degree rotation on a five pixel square rasterises to mush. The tilt narrows but never closes and the gap widens but never fills, because those two are the argument.

MICRO · 32 / 24 / 16

PRIMARY AT THE SAME SIZES

Asphalt, chalk, signal

Asphalt is the block, chalk is the ground, and signal is the piece that left. Nothing else appears inside the mark.

Asphalt
#14161B
The block. Sets type on light grounds.
15.61:1 on chalk · body text

Chalk
#F0EEE9
The ground. A warm off-white, not a pure one.
16.87:1 on night · body text

Signal
#FF5A1F
The alpha. One place at a time.
2.69:1 on chalk · shapes only

Signal lift
#FF7A45
Signal on dark grounds.
7.56:1 on night · body text

Night
#0B0C0F
The dark page ground.
16.87:1 on chalk · body text

Slate
#5E6673
Secondary text.
5.00:1 on chalk · body text

Why ember

Every other room in this market is navy, green, or violet, which is why none of them can be told apart in a sidebar of circular avatars. A brand that cannot be picked out of that list at sixteen pixels has failed at the only job the avatar has. Signal is a decision, not an accident: orange is warm, it is loud, and nobody here owns it.

Contrast, checked rather than felt

PAIRING	RATIO	SAFE FOR
Signal on chalk	2.69:1	shapes only
Signal lift on night	7.56:1	body
Asphalt on chalk	15.61:1	body
Chalk on night	16.87:1	body
Slate on chalk	5.00:1	body
Slate lift on night	7.51:1	body

> Signal on chalk is 2.69 to 1. That is fine for the tile, which is a shape rather than something to be read, and fine for display type. Signal at body size on a light ground fails. Set it large, or set it on asphalt.

Semantic colour is not drawn from signal

Signal means "this is the alpha". If it also meant "this worked", a filled order and a fresh call would be the same colour.

Chivo, Inter, JetBrains Mono

OffTheBlock

`Chivo 800 · tracking -0.022em · outlined, no font required`

The wordmark is one word with its internal capitals kept. It is a handle before it is a title, so it is not "Off The Block" and it is not "offtheblock". The tracking is pulled in because the name is eleven letters and at default spacing it sprawls.

Chivo, for the wordmark and headings

A grotesque with square shoulders and a flat, blunt black weight. The mark is built out of right angles, and a typeface with soft humanist bowls would argue with it.

Inter, for body and interface

A plain workhorse. It gets out of the way, which is the entire job.

JetBrains Mono, for anything that lines up

`0O 1lI · So1anaVsPh...9xKq · 1,284.05`

This is not decoration. This is a room where people paste contract addresses, and a mono with a slashed zero and an unmistakable 1, l, and I is the difference between reading an address and losing money to one. Columns of figures take `tabular-nums`, or a price list jitters as its digits change.

> All three are SIL Open Font License, which permits commercial use and embedding. They are self-hosted as woff2, so nothing reaches a font CDN at runtime. All three are variable, so one file covers every weight.

Where the word goes

HORIZONTAL

The block's foot stands on the word's baseline, so the mark sits on the same line the type does rather than floating beside it.

The gap is measured from the block's right edge, not from the mark's bounding box. The bounding box is defined by the tile, which is up in the corner with nothing underneath it, so spacing the word off the box opens a hole under the tile and the lockup falls into two pieces. Measured off the block instead, the word closes up and runs beneath the tile, and the tile's diagonal points into the name. The tile must never touch the caps; that daylight is asserted in the build, and the build fails if it closes.

STACKED

KNOCKOUT

The stacked lockup does not centre on the bounding box

The mark balances at 38% across, not the 50% its bounding box claims. Almost all of its weight is block, thrown into one corner, with the tile as a small counterweight thrown to the other. Centring the word on the box hangs it off a point with no ink anywhere near it, and it visibly leans.

06 · SIZES AND CROPS

Every size is a different crop

Telegram and Discord crop an avatar to a circle of the full width. The mark runs corner to corner, so at full bleed the tile is the first thing the crop takes off, and the logo ships as a plain square with a corner missing.

FULL BLEED · THE TILE IS SHAVED OFF

SCALED TO THE INSCRIBED SQUARE

A square bounding box of side s only fits inside a circle of diameter D when $s \times \sqrt{2} \le D$. So avatar artwork is scaled to 0.707 of the frame. This is geometry, not padding taste.

```
favicon     a square, shown as drawn
apple-touch  a square; iOS rounds the corners, so they hold no ink
maskable     Android may crop to a circle of 80% of the width
avatar       Telegram and Discord crop to a circle of the full width
```

> `build-icons.py` asserts this rather than trusting it: it counts the mark pixels left outside each crop circle and reports zero. A silent miss here ships a broken avatar to every member of the room.

Clear space

Give the mark clear space on every side equal to the tile's width.

07 · MOTION

The piece comes off

The mark is already a before and an after. The tile starts in the notch, square and flush, and it ends clear of the block and tilted. The animation is not a new idea laid over the logo: it is the interpolation between the logo's own two states, and the last frame is asserted at build time to be the mark itself.

0.00s 0.07s 0.16s 0.32s 0.59s 0.90s

The block does not move

The block is the settled thing. That is what the word means, and it is why the tile is the only thing in the mark carrying a tilt. Animate the block and the mark stops making its argument. Nothing may move but the piece that left.

It is not hinged

The tile turns about its own centre while it travels. Rotating it about the block's corner would swing it, and a swing is a hinge, and a hinge is a lid. This piece is not attached to anything. It came off.

The numbers

```
from (-8.00, 8.00) at 0deg, in the notch
to (12.20, -12.20) at 14deg, off the block
0.9s, cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.9, 0.2, 1.06)
loop: 0.9s out, 1.4s held, 0.35s gone, 0.25s empty
```

Position and rotation ride the same curve, so the piece stops turning exactly when it stops travelling. The ease overshoots a little: it leaves fast, arrives, and settles a hair past where it lands. A linear travel reads as a machine moving a part, not as something coming loose.

Where each file goes

The standalone SVGs animate themselves with SMIL, because they get used inside an `<img>`, and an `<img>` is an isolated document a host page's CSS cannot reach into. The site's inline mark uses CSS instead, so it can be switched off for a reader who has asked for reduced motion. SMIL cannot be, which is the whole reason the page does not use it.

How it talks

Plain and direct. This is a room of people who can tell when they are being sold to, so do not sell to them. Say the thing. Prefer concrete words: alpha, signal, call, room, shipped. Avoid "ecosystem", "leveraging", "next-generation", and every other word that survives only because nobody reads it.

The house line is **"Before it hits the block."** It explains the name and the product in five words, which is the only reason to have a line at all.

Rules worth keeping

- Do not rotate, recolour, or restyle the mark.
- Do not close the gap and do not straighten the tile. Those two are the logo.
- Do not put the signal tile on a signal ground.
- Clear space on every side equal to the tile's width.
- Below 24px, use the micro variant.
- One colour? Use the mono file, and let the notch and the gap carry it.
- Signal goes in one place at a time. It is the alpha, not an accent.
- Never draw semantic colour out of signal.
- In motion, only the tile moves. The block is settled; that is the point.

Every figure in this guide is read from brand/geometry.py and brand/motion.py at build time. Change the mark and the guide changes with it. Rebuild: python brand/build-guide.py